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21LEM202T — Unit 3, Session 7, SLO 2

Part A — Key Ideas (Recap)

• 'An Inconvenient Truth' (2006, presented by Al Gore) is a documentary about global climate change. It asks: "What were you doing when you had the time to do something?" We discuss the state of the planet, the root cause of the problems and the solution.

• Root cause as stated in the film: new technology + old habits, and our way of thinking — in particular the assumption that the Earth is so big that humans cannot have any lasting impact on it. With incorrect assumptions, the recognition and fulfilment are also incorrect — they are neither mutually enriching with nature nor mutually fulfilling for the human being.

• Restated problem: population becomes population without right understanding; new technology + old habits becomes technology developed and used with wrong assumptions; our way of thinking becomes thinking on the basis of wrong assumptions (preconditioning, sensation).

• The current approach treats the problem as one of population/technology and responds with more technology — which is only symptomatic, temporary relief. The all-encompassing solution (samadhan) is human education, human conduct, human constitution and human order; exploitation of nature and domination are only the symptoms of inhuman conduct.

• The four orders of nature and their basis: physical/material order (soil, metal — constitution-based), bio/pranic order (plants, trees — seed-based), animal order (animals, birds — breed-based, will to live), and human order (human beings — education-sanskar based, right understanding, will to live with continuous happiness). Human participation for mutual fulfilment means facilitating (or at least not violating) the conducive environment, the innateness and the inheritance of each order.

This is a recap section with no blanks to fill. The key ideas are: the film discusses global climate change; root cause is new technology + old habits + wrong assumptions (Earth too big to be impacted); restated problem includes population without right understanding, technology with wrong assumptions, thinking based on wrong assumptions; current approach is symptomatic relief, samadhan is human education, conduct, constitution, order; four orders are physical (constitution-based), bio (seed-based), animal (breed-based), human (education-sanskar based).

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1: Complete the three parts of the root cause, as stated in the film.

• New technology + **exploitative mindset**
• Our way of **living**
• The assumption: the Earth is so big that **it can absorb all our waste and provide unlimited resources**

Activity 2: Mark each item as Symptomatic relief or part of the All-encompassing solution (samadhan).

Item	Symptom / Solution
Applying technology and do's & don'ts	**Symptomatic relief**
Human education	**All-encompassing solution**
Human conduct	**All-encompassing solution**
Human constitution and human order	**All-encompassing solution**

Activity 3: Match each order of nature to its basis.

Order	Basis (constitution / seed / breed / education-sanskar)
Physical / material (soil, metal)	**Constitution**
Bio / pranic (plants, trees)	**Seed**
Animal (animals, birds)	**Breed**
Human (human beings)	**Education-sanskar**

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Q1. What does the film state as the root cause of the environmental problems? [5]

The film states that the root cause of environmental problems is the combination of new technology with an exploitative mindset, our way of living that is not in harmony with nature, and the false assumption that the Earth is so big that it can absorb all our waste and provide unlimited resources. This leads to overexploitation and degradation of the environment.

Q2. Distinguish the current (symptomatic) approach from the all-encompassing solution (samadhan). [5]

The current symptomatic approach focuses on applying technology and do's and don'ts to address environmental problems as they arise, without addressing the root cause. It provides temporary relief but does not change the fundamental human mindset. The all-encompassing solution (samadhan) addresses the root cause by focusing on human education, human conduct, and understanding human constitution and human order. It aims to transform human consciousness and behavior so that harmony with nature is naturally established.

Q3. What is the human role in nature with respect to the four orders? [5]

The human role in nature is to facilitate the conducive environment, the innateness, and the inheritance of all four orders: physical, bio, animal, and human. Humans have the unique capacity for right understanding and should use it to ensure that each order functions in harmony. This means not violating the natural processes and instead actively supporting the well-being of all orders.

Q4. After watching the film, write your observations on the state of the planet and one thing you can do (in your conduct) towards the solution. [5]

The film shows that the planet is suffering from severe environmental degradation, including pollution, resource depletion, and loss of biodiversity, all due to human exploitation. One thing I can do in my conduct is to reduce my consumption of single-use plastics and adopt a more sustainable lifestyle, such as carrying reusable bags and bottles, and also spreading awareness among my peers about the importance of living in harmony with nature.

Self-Reflection (Take-Home)

• Are we playing our role in nature — facilitating (or at least not violating) the conducive environment, the innateness and the inheritance of all orders? (Slide 9)

• Which of your daily habits add to the exploitation of nature, and which could be changed with right understanding?

• Yes, I believe we are not fully playing our role; we often violate the conducive environment by polluting and overexploiting resources, and we do not always respect the innateness and inheritance of other orders.

• Daily habits that add to exploitation include using single-use plastics, wasting water and electricity, and consuming more than needed. These could be changed with right understanding by adopting minimalism, recycling, and being mindful of our consumption patterns.